It’s the mobile demo form, not SEO: fix it this week and hold the budget move

WHAT’S HAPPENING

1. **Mobile demo requests have halved since form v2 went live on 29 June.** The new phone check rejects 42% of mobile attempts (it was 3%). Desktop hasn’t moved.

2. **The last two weeks look worse than they are.** Since 6 July the dashboard counts cohorts before they’ve had 14 days to qualify. Like-for-like, qualified leads are down 17%, starting 29 June.

3. **Search is healthy, so SEO isn’t the cause.** Clicks, impressions and rankings are flat. Paid mobile traffic hits the same form, so moving the $8k retainer into paid won’t fix it.

WHAT’S AT STAKE

−$222k OBSERVED

qualified pipeline a week vs June, like-for-like

$1.0–1.1M ESTIMATE

pipeline not created since 29 June

~$50k SCENARIO

of annual contract value for each week unfixed, at a 20% win rate. Not revenue.

DECISIONS FOR MONDAY

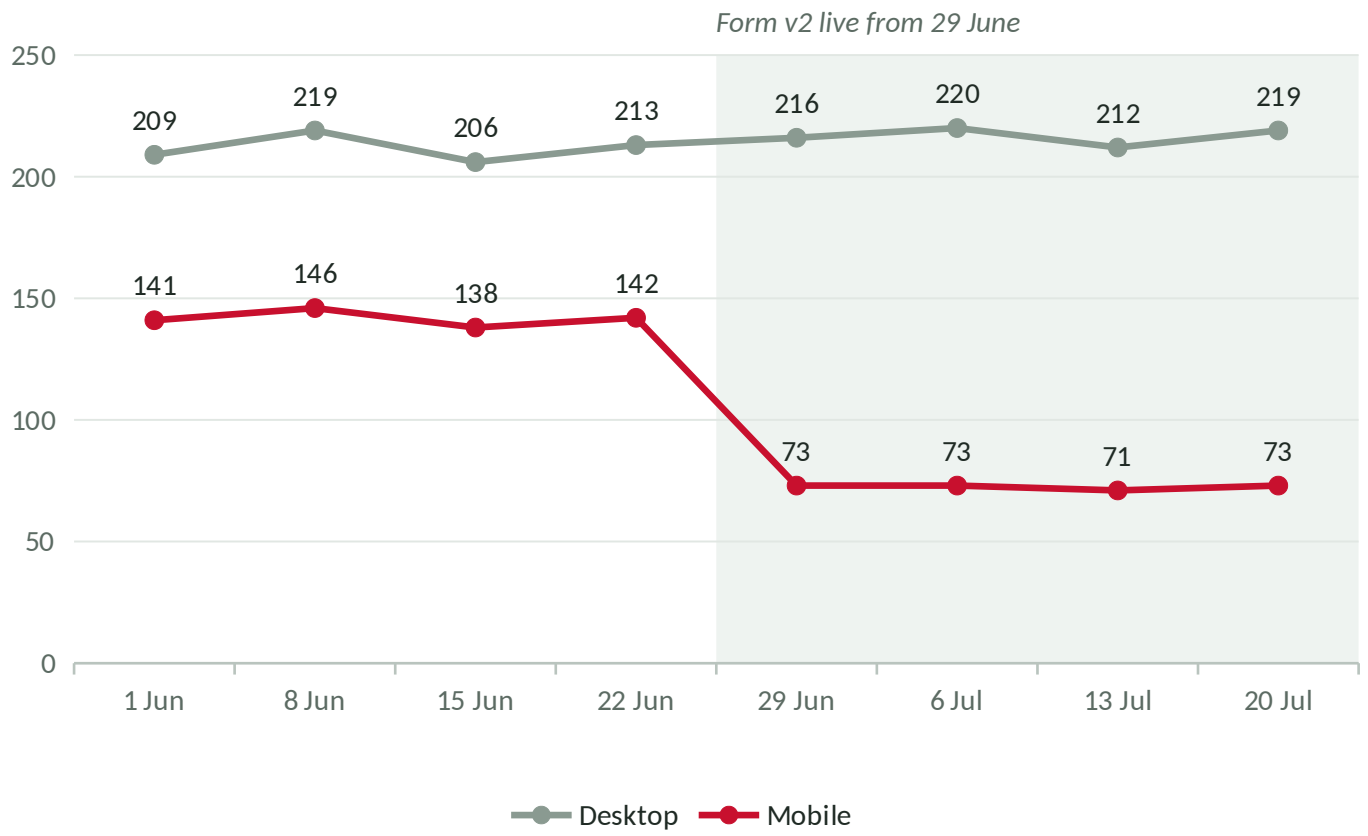
1. **Roll back the mobile phone check**
   Product · within 48 hours
2. **Report pipeline on 14-day cohorts**
   RevOps · before the CEO pack
3. **Keep SEO; revisit budget mid-September**
   CMO · on clean data

Sources: 01 search performance, 02 website funnel, 03 form diagnostics, 04 CRM cohorts. June = weeks of 1–22 Jun; since v2 = 29 Jun–20 Jul. Every number is traced in the workbook’s source map.

Mobile demo requests halved the week form v2 went live; desktop didn’t move

Demo requests per week, by device

OBSERVED



What changed, and what didn’t

Weekly average	June	Since v2
Sessions	3,939	4,027
Search clicks	1,515	1,549
Mobile form starts	177	181
Mobile completion	**80%**	**40%**
Desktop completion	80%	80%

Mobile requests fell ~50% in every channel

Organic **−49%**	Paid **−49%**
Direct **−48%**	Referral **−50%**

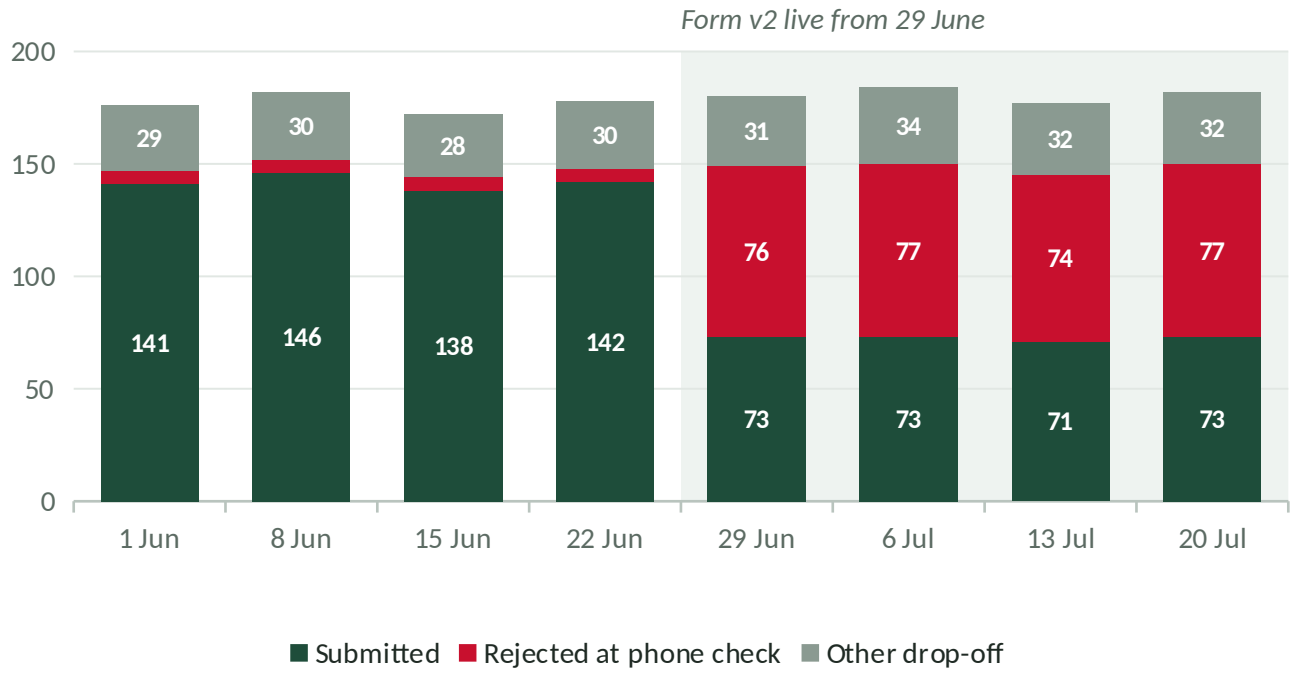
A channel problem would hit one channel. This hit one device.

Sources: 02 website funnel (sessions, form_starts, form_submissions) and 01 search performance (clicks). Weekly averages; completion = requests ÷ starts.

The new phone check is turning away four in ten mobile attempts

Mobile form attempts per week, by outcome

OBSERVED



What we can't say yet: whether the rejected numbers were real. No controlled test was run. Server logs will show it; if most were fake, the loss is smaller than shown.

3% → 42%

of mobile attempts rejected at the phone field, June vs since v2

4% → 4%

the same measure on desktop

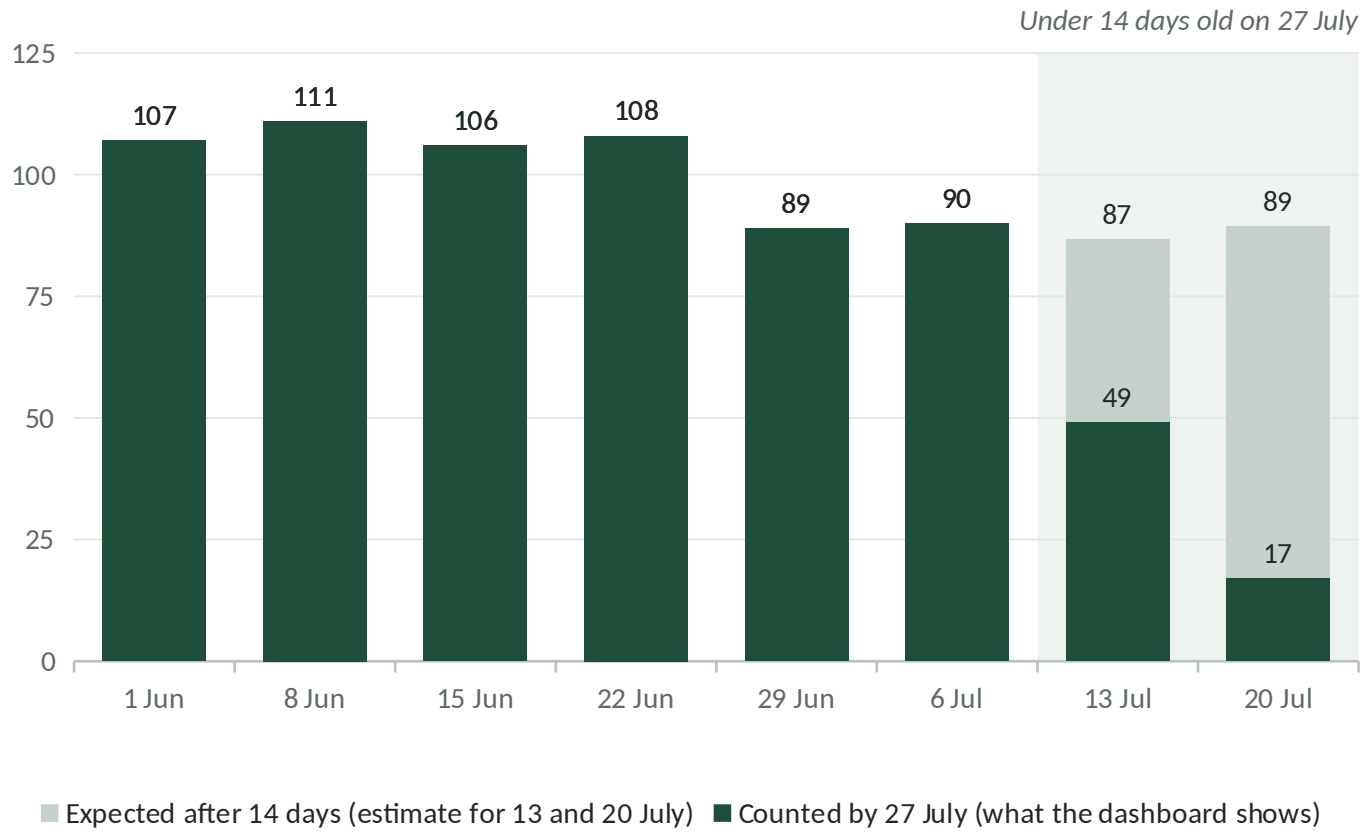
- Rejections went from about 6 to 76 a week, roughly the 70 mobile requests a week we're missing.
- Other drop-off barely moved (17% → 18%). People finish the form, then get turned away.
- Mobile leads that still get through qualify at the same rate as in June (about 31%). If the check were screening out junk, that rate should have gone up.

Sources: 03 form diagnostics (attempts, phone_validation_rejections, abandoned_other); 04 CRM cohorts (14-day qualification, mature cohorts only).

The ‘last two weeks’ slump is a counting change, not a new drop

Qualified leads by acquisition week

OBSERVED ESTIMATE



49 and 17

OBSERVED

qualified leads the dashboard shows for the weeks of 13 and 20 July ($588k and $204k of pipeline)

Those cohorts had only 8–14 and 1–7 days to qualify. Since 6 July the dashboard counts them as if they were finished.

~87 and ~89

ESTIMATE

expected once they reach 14 days, in line with the two weeks before

–17%

OBSERVED

the real like-for-like drop: 108 → 90 qualified a week on 14-day cohorts, starting 29 June

Sources: 04 CRM cohorts (qualified_within_14_days, qualified_as_of_snapshot, pipeline_created_usd_as_of_snapshot); 06 changes. Estimates apply 14-day rates by channel and device from the six mature cohorts.

Each week unfixed costs about $250k of pipeline; moving SEO money to paid won't recover it

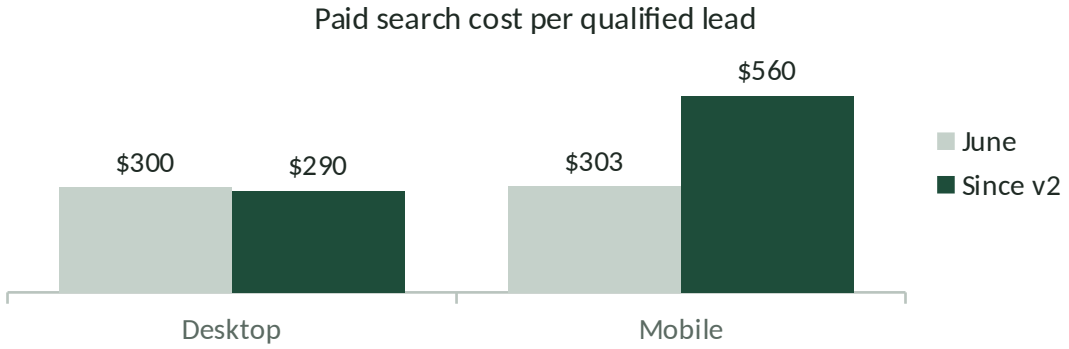
What's at stake

Measure	Pipeline	Basis
Qualified pipeline a week, June → since v2	$1.30M → $1.07M	**Observed**
Change a week (mobile / desktop)	−$222k (−$243k / +$21k)	**Observed**
Not created, 29 June to 26 July	$1.0–1.1M	***Estimate***
Each further week unfixed	~$250k	***Estimate***
Contract value at a 20% win rate	~$200k so far, ~$50k a week	**Scenario**

Pipeline isn't revenue. It's $12k of potential annual contract value per qualified lead. ROI needs won deals, sales-cycle length, margin and lifetime value by cohort, and we don't have them.

What would change our view on budget: page-to-lead data showing non-brand organic drives little qualified pipeline, or a paid test showing extra spend keeps June's return.

The proposed move: $8k a month from SEO to paid



- Paid mobile clicks land on the same broken form, so extra spend before the fix buys more rejections.
- $8k more a month in paid buys about $320k of pipeline at June's average return, likely less at the margin.
- Organic made about $2.6M of pipeline a month in June. If SEO sustains even 12% of that, it beats the paid alternative.
- Rankings are flat (1.2 brand, 5.4 non-brand), but June's new content hasn't lifted impressions. Review what the retainer delivers in September.

Sources: 04 CRM cohorts, 05 paid spend, 01 search performance. 14-day qualified only (since v2 = 29 Jun and 6 Jul cohorts). Budgets were flat all period, so paid's marginal return is untested.

Fix the form, fix the reporting, then decide budget on clean data

#	Action	Owner	When	We'll know it worked when
1	Roll back v2's phone validation on mobile, then re-release the fix as a 50/50 test	Product / web engineering	Rollback within 48 hours	Mobile rejections under 5% of attempts; ~140 mobile requests in the first full week
2	Pull server logs for rejected attempts. If contact details were kept and consent allows, sales follows up	Engineering + sales ops	This week	Cause named; we know how many of the ~300 rejected requests can be recovered
3	Report pipeline on 14-day cohorts; show newer weeks as 'maturing'	RevOps / analyst	Before Monday's CEO pack	13 and 20 July cohorts land near 87 and 89 qualified
4	Hold the SEO-to-paid move; revisit with four clean weeks and page-to-lead data	CMO, with us	Mid-September	Budget set on qualified pipeline by page, not total leads

If the rollback slips past a week: lower mobile bids in paid search until it ships (paid search lead).

WHAT WE'D DEFER, AND WHY

Changing the SEO budget
It isn't the cause, and cutting now would blur its lagged effect with the fix.

Copying competitor demo paths
The notes show pages, not results. Once the form is back to baseline, test making phone optional.

Reacting to 'ranking volatility'
Our rankings haven't moved in eight weeks: brand 1.2, non-brand 5.4.

Success thresholds come from the June baseline: mobile rejections 3% of attempts, completion 80%, ~142 mobile requests a week. Workbook tabs: Pre vs post, Cohorts.